



User Story Mapping

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🌟 TL; DR

🌟 This article explains **User Story Mapping**, a visual technique for structuring product features around user interactions, helping teams prioritize development efficiently. It contrasts **User Story Maps** with **Customer Journey Maps**, outlining how they work together to align user needs with business goals. The article covers key benefits like **collaboration, speed, user focus, risk reduction, and resource efficiency**, along with a breakdown of **activities, tasks, and user stories** within a structured roadmap. It also includes useful resources, a video explainer, and an AI-generated prompt used for developing a Swatched Inc. roadmap.

🏔️ What are User Story Maps?

A **user story map** is a visual representation of a product's features and functionalities, structured around how users interact with the product. It helps product teams **prioritize development** and ensure that features align with user needs according to the business time and/or budget constraints:

[A customer journey map](#) (created usually by UX designers) is a **broader view** of how users interact with a product or service across different touchpoints.

📋 How They Work Together:

1. **Start with a Customer Journey Map** (understand emotions, pain points and outline opportunities aka. potential business solutions).
2. **Translate key touchpoints into a User Story Map** (define and prioritize features based on experience phases).
3. **Use the Story Map as an Agile Development Roadmap:** weight stories and split deliveries throughout sprints or iterations.

💡 Benefits

- **Alignment & Collaboration** – Helps teams stay aligned with a shared vision.
- **Speed & Simplicity** – Quickly document ideas and iterate without lengthy business plans.
- **User-Centric Approach** – Focuses on solving real problems for real users.
- **Risk Reduction** – Identifies assumptions early to validate before investing heavily.
- **Efficient Resource Allocation** – Prioritizes critical features and market strategies.

📌 Structure

1. **Activities (High-Level Goals):** Major actions a user takes during their user experience (e.g., "Sign Up," "Browse Products," "Checkout").
2. **User Tasks (Steps within Activities):** Specific steps users take to achieve their goal (e.g., "Enter email," "Select payment method").
3. **User Stories (Detailed Features):** Specific functionalities that support tasks (e.g., "As a user, I want to reset my password").
4. **UX Phases (X-axis):** Activities and user tasks are grouped based on [AARRR](#) customer journey or something similar.
5. **Prioritization & Releases (Y-axis):** Stories are arranged based on importance, helping teams **plan iterative releases** (MVP, future iterations).

👉 Good Reads

Here's a presentation we made in 2024 on how to merge both approaches:

 shared via SharePoint

https://sukrasoft-my.sharepoint.com/:b/g/personal/etorre_arkusnexus_com/EUMHXZqKO9Fnt...



More formal training from other sources:

Mapping User Stories in Agile - NN/g

User-story maps help Agile teams define what to build and maintain visibility for how it all fits together. They enable user-centered conversations,...

<https://www.nngroup.com/articles/user-story-mapping/>



User Story Mapping – The Complete Guide [Examples Inside]

User story mapping is a user-centric planning technique for product teams. Read more for our complete step-by-step guide and examples of story maps.

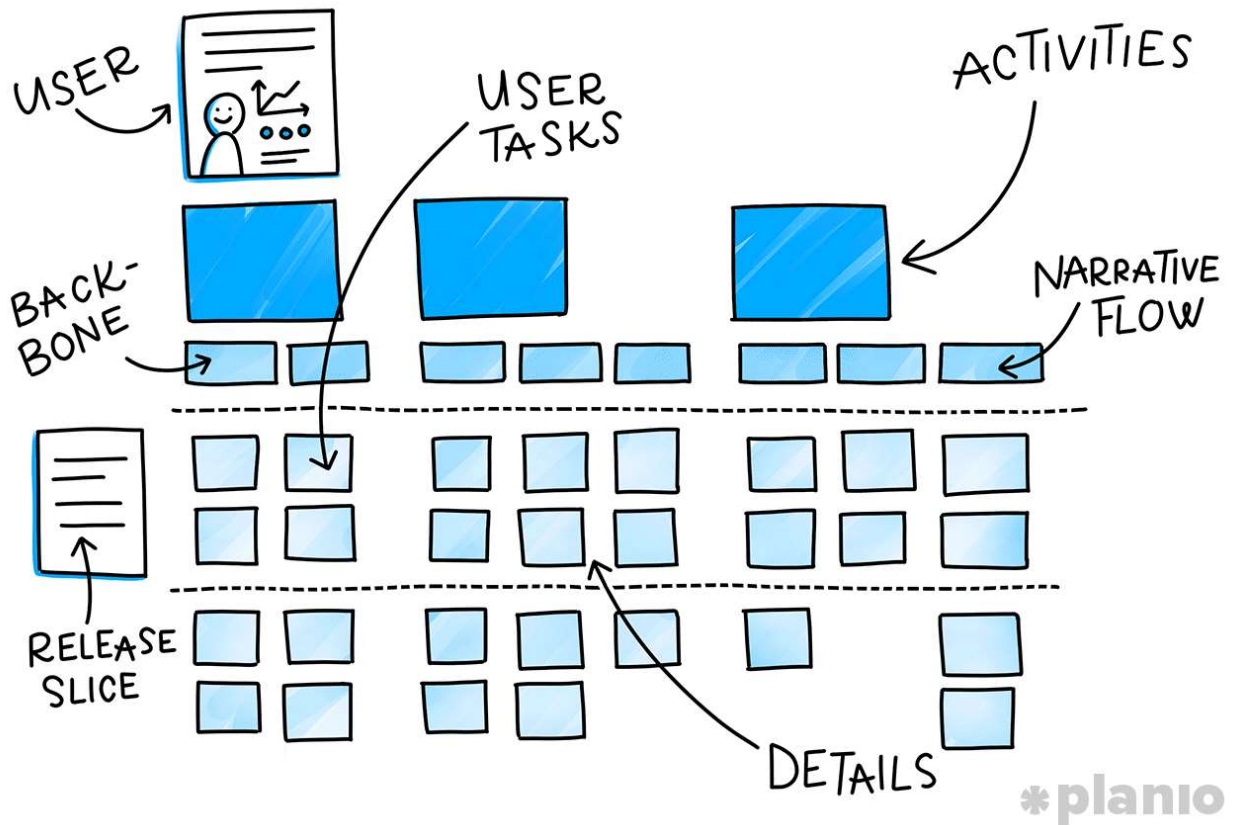
<https://www.avion.io/what-is-user-story-mapping/>



📺 Video Explainer

 <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=TaMLUf3gISo>

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=TaMLUf3gISo>

 User Story Maps Examples

User-Story Map: Mobile App Feature for Depositing Checks

NNGROUP.COM NN/g

1. Activities:

High-level tasks users can do in the digital product

Check account balance

Deposit a check

2. Steps:

Steps users go through to complete the activity above

Login

Access accounts

Enter mobile deposit details

Sign check

Photograph check

Submit deposit

Confirm deposit

Enter username or email

View account balances

Choose account

Read tips for taking check photos

Enable camera access

Confirm deposit

View confirmation message

Enter password

See pending transactions

Enter deposit amount

Turn phone horizontal

Understand amount available

Receive email confirmation

Press login button

Open new account

View transaction limits

Take photo of front & back

Cancel deposit

Initiate forgot password

See legal disclosures

Send check to bank via drone

Autofill numbers

Get instant access to all funds

View deposit in past deposits

Toggle remember me

Get savings advice

View past deposits

Review error messages

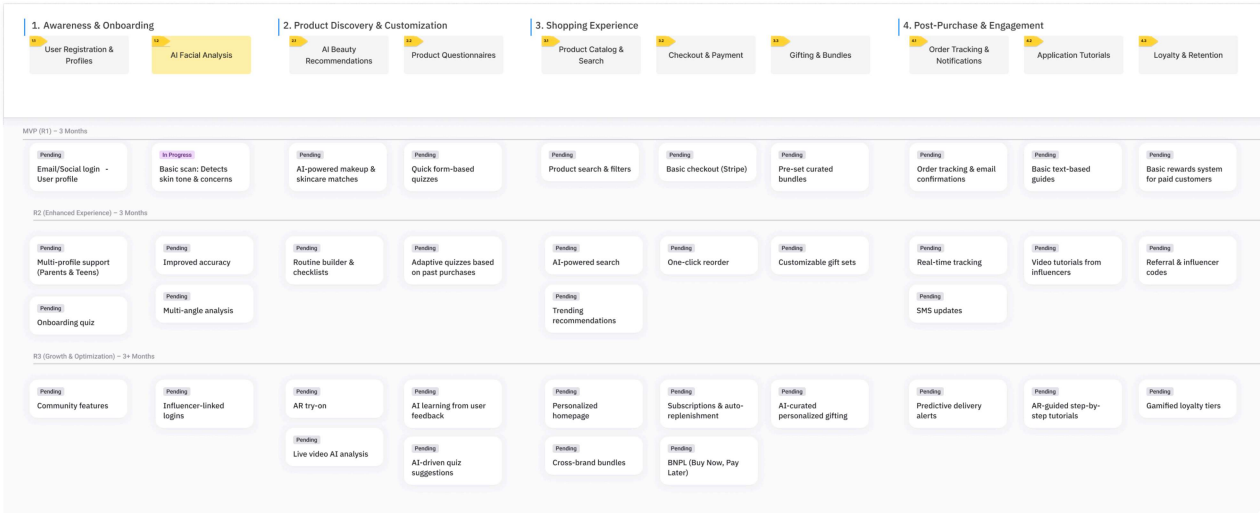
Receive text message

Real Study Case leveraging AI

<https://www.swatched.com/>

ArkusNexus' Client Startup **Swatched** led by a famous Hollywood Stylist / Makeup artist that wants to replicate his knowledge of makeup and skincare in an AI tool that can analyze people faces to suggest styling combinations and/or skincare routines in order to convince people to buy packages of products that work together, reducing confusion for newcomers, specially men. Swatched will include guidance on how to apply the beauty products and routine checklists. Swatched's vision is to create a service/e-commerce site that can gain popularity through young influencers and eventually organically with customers.





AI Generation Prompt Used

Using the [Prompting Formula](#):

[persona]

You're a product designer working for startup company called Swatched that plans to launch an e-commerce site that allow customers to buy cosmetic and personal care products from multiple brands starting with makeup, lipstick, skin care, hair care, etc. The main differentiator is that this website would be the following 4 key features:

[context]

1. Advanced Facial Analysis: Our AI-powered facial analysis goes beyond the basics. It accurately identifies subtle skin tone variations across different facial zones, detects specific skin concerns like redness or hyperpigmentation, and provides personalized product recommendations based on this detailed analysis.
2. Expert Recommendation System: Our recommendation system isn't just about matching colors. It uses expert knowledge, color guidelines, and a deep understanding of makeup formulas and finishes to provide truly personalized recommendations. This ensures users find products that not only match their skin tone but also meet their individual needs and preferences.
3. Efficient Questionnaires: Our product-specific questionnaires are designed to be quick and efficient, ensuring users only answer relevant questions. This saves time and allows for a more personalized experience. We also plan to adapt and customize these questionnaires based on user feedback and new product offerings.
4. One-Stop Shop for Beauty: Our platform offers a convenient one-stop shop for all makeup needs. Users can purchase products from various brands on a single platform, streamlining their shopping experience. We handle inventory management, order fulfillment, and customer service for all brands, ensuring a seamless and enjoyable experience for users.

We would like to target a US demographic of young adults, mainly gen-z and millennial women. Our primary target would be teens and young women; however, since they're likely to be restricted to make purchases online, we would like to add

adults the ability to set up multiple profiles for their household to include their kids, so they can also create their own avatar using the facial scan feature and questionnaire features.

[task]

You're now a software manager working for Swatched and you just received green light to start planning the development of the Swatched platform. Develop an agile roadmap using the Story Map format to outline the development releases, consider a team of 3 developers, 1 QA, 1 UI/UX designer and a project manager.

[format]

The story map / roadmap should have the following elements (y axis):

- Themes (based on the use journey phases)
- Epics
- Releases (starting with the MVP as first release)

Include the development estimation for each user story using the T-shirt sizing technique where 1 sprint is 2 weeks and the following equivalent for t-shirts:

- S = 1/2 Sprint
- M = 1 Sprint
- L = 2 Sprints
- XL = 4 Sprints or 1 month

Mark user stories with a high development risk.

[tone]

Use a clean and concise language and write the map with few words when possible.